



SQL OF THE DAY

mind the ties

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StrataScratch · #10060

Nivan RS





THE PROBLEM

Find the review text with the highest number of cool votes. Return the business name and the review text.

ties disappear...

Medium · PostgreSQL

Nivan RS





THE SOLUTION

```
WITH rank_list AS (  
    SELECT business_name,  
           review_text,  
           cool,  
           DENSE_RANK() OVER (  
               ORDER BY cool DESC  
           ) AS rnk  
    FROM yelp_reviews  
)  
SELECT business_name,  
       review_text  
FROM rank_list  
WHERE rnk = 1;
```





HOW IT WORKS

RANK EVERY REVIEW

DENSE_RANK() OVER (ORDER BY cool DESC) ranks every review, highest votes first.

TIES SHARE A RANK

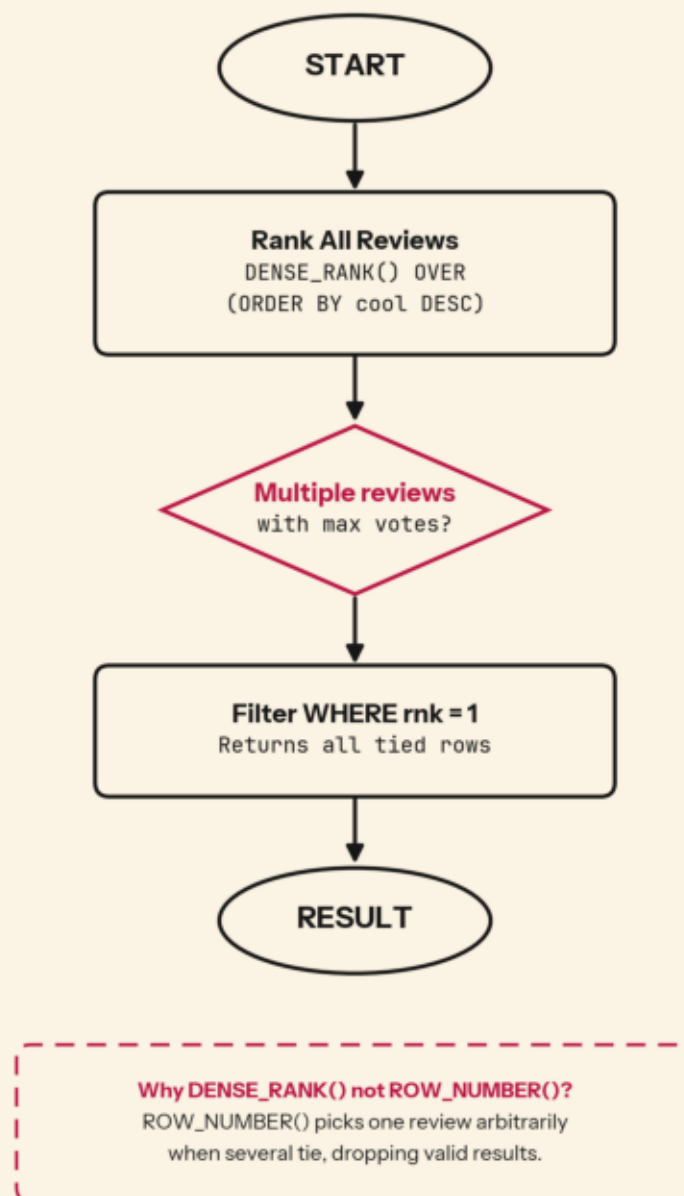
Two reviews with 10 cool votes both get rank 1, not rank 1 and rank 2.

KEEP THE TOP

WHERE rnk = 1 returns every top review, not one arbitrary row.



THE LOGIC





WHY IT MATTERS

01

Content discovery

Platforms surface top content with queries like this. Drop a tie and a valid recommendation never reaches users.

02

Earned visibility

A tied business loses visibility it earned, and the product recommends less-liked content while looking correct.

03

Editorial trust

A 'most loved review' feature that shows one of several tied winners looks arbitrary when a reader spots an equal review left out.





KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1 `ROW_NUMBER()` forces unique numbers (1, 2, 3, 4) and silently drops tied rows.
- 2 `RANK()` keeps ties but skips ranks (1, 1, 3, 4). `DENSE_RANK()` keeps ties with no gap (1, 1, 2, 3).
- 3 For all rows tied at the top, `DENSE_RANK()` works, and so does `WHERE cool = (SELECT MAX(cool) ...)`.

follow for more SQL problems

questions? nivanrs@gmail.com

